



DIGGING UP A DINOSAUR



Dinosaur fossils are very rare, because they are only found buried in certain types of rocks. Dinosaurs became extinct at the end of the Cretaceous period, so any rock that formed after this time does not contain any dinosaur fossils. Rocks at the bottom of the sea are usually free of dinosaur fossils, because dinosaurs lived on land. The best places to hunt for dinosaur bones are in rock layers that formed at the bottom of swamps, lakes, or rivers.

Drawing fossils is an important job on a dinosaur dig.

The rock around the fossil has been slowly and carefully chipped away.

This skeleton has been very well preserved. Most of the skeleton is still buried under the ground.

This Tyrannosaurus rex skeleton is 39 feet (12 meters) long. It is lying curled up on its left side.

